

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-14

Cost Management Plan

How costs will be estimated, budgeted, managed and controlled

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Cost Management Plan
Document reference	PMB-14-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager with finance
Approver	Sponsor and finance
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-15	Cost Estimates and Basis of Estimates	Produced under this plan
PMB-16	Cost Baseline and Funding Requirements	Produced under this plan
PMB-29	Earned Value Analysis Report	Reports under these rules

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Establishes how project costs will be planned, structured and controlled — the estimating approach, precision, units, control thresholds, earned value rules and reporting formats.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Cost Management — Plan Cost Management
Created when	During planning
Reviewed / updated	Through change control once baselined
Owner	Project manager with finance
Approver	Sponsor and finance
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Align the control account structure to the organisation's finance system from the start. Retro-fitting a cost structure to match finance coding is expensive and error-prone.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The cost structure maps to the organisation's chart of accounts
- Control thresholds are numeric with defined escalation
- Reserve types are distinguished, with different owners and release rules
- Earned value rules are stated if earned value is being used
- Currency, inflation and exchange rate treatment is stated where relevant

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1. Cost management approach

Field	Detail
Units of measure	Working days for schedule; AED for cost; hours for effort
Currency	AED, with USD-denominated hardware converted at the pegged rate of 1 USD = 3.6725 AED
Level of precision	Rounded to the nearest AED 1,000
Level of accuracy	-5% to +10% for the current tranche
Organisational procedures link	Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform
Control account level	WBS level 1
Chart of accounts mapping	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line
Inflation / exchange rate treatment	No inflation applied within the tranche; the dirham peg removes material currency exposure

2. Estimating approach

Phase	Technique	Expected accuracy	Basis
Order of magnitude	Analogous	-25% to +75%	Chargeback introduces cost where compute was previously free
Budget estimate	Parametric / bottom-up	-10% to +25%	AED 17,800,000
Definitive estimate	Bottom-up	-5% to +10%	Chargeback introduces cost where compute was previously free

3. Cost categories

Category	Definition	Capital or operating	Finance code
Internal labour	Sustained aggregate read throughput from the storage tier to the compute estate	Capex	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line
External labour	Total facility energy divided by IT energy over a rolling 12 months	Capex	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line
Software licences	Achieved business value divided by planned business value across the planning interval	Capex	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line
Hardware and infrastructure	The proportion of accelerator time doing useful work, sampled every five minutes	Capex	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line

Category	Definition	Capital or operating	Finance code
Third party services	Helios AI Platform ART	Opex	Helios AI Platform ART
Training	Total facility energy divided by IT energy over a rolling 12 months	Opex	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line
Contingency	Total facility energy divided by IT energy over a rolling 12 months	Opex	GT-INF-HEL cost centre, capital and operating split per line

4. Control thresholds

Measure	Green	Amber	Red	Escalation at amber	Escalation at red
Cost variance	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three
Cost performance index	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three
Estimate at completion vs budget	AED 11,200,000	AED 240,000	AED 1,120,000	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three
Contingency drawn down	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build	Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams	Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three

5. Earned value rules

Rule	Definition for this project
EVM technique	<i>Dashboard published to the programme site</i>
Percent complete rules	<i>Yes</i>
Level of effort treatment	<i>Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover</i>
Estimate at completion formula	<i>Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance</i>
Reporting frequency	<i>Monthly to the Programme Board, weekly to the Programme Manager</i>

6. Reserve management

Reserve	Amount / basis	Owner	Release process	Reporting
Contingency reserve	Known-unknowns; from risk analysis	Project manager	<i>AED 9,400,000, derived from expected value of identified risks; drawn by the Programme Manager against a named risk</i>	<i>AED 9,400,000, derived from expected value of identified risks; drawn by the Programme Manager against a named risk</i>
Management reserve	Unknown-unknowns	Sponsor	<i>AED 5,200,000, held outside the cost baseline and released by the SRO only</i>	<i>AED 5,200,000, held outside the cost baseline and released by the SRO only</i>

7. Funding and cash flow

Aspect	Detail
Funding limit reconciliation	<i>Tranche 2 funding of AED 118m is released at the 18 Sep 2026 gate; cumulative spend does not exceed cumulative funding in any month</i>
Funding tranches	<i>Tranche 3</i>
Invoicing and accrual approach	<i>Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps and security</i>
Cost reporting to finance	<i>AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation</i>